FORSYS
Forward Thinking

CASE STUDY

Accelerated Closures & Increased Financial Forecasting Accuracy with Oracle PBCS Implementation

Summary

A global consumer entertainment products company's traditional approach to financial planning, budgeting, and forecasting began to show its age. The financial reporting processes were dependent on a myriad of disconnected Excel spreadsheets, resulting in inaccurate data, lower business productivity and a lack of actionable insight to support critical business decision-making.

Forsys implemented Oracle Planning and Budgeting Cloud Service (PBCS) which streamlined and automated the client's planning and budget forecast processes leading to a 40-50% jump in business productivity.

Problem Statement

The client's existing on-premises financial application failed to offer the flexibility and scalability needed to manage its complex accounts structure and fast pace of growth. The customer has products for both the supply side and demand side of the digital video ecosystem. Hence, the close cycles (both quarterly and annual) have become lengthy and often need several weeks to complete.

The client complained that the upgrades and patches hampered productivity as they had become disruptive to maintain and time-consuming. Additionally, the client used Excel spreadsheets for financial planning and budgeting activities, which led to frequent data errors and corruption.

The above-mentioned challenges pushed the client to identify and implement a modern, integrated finance and planning solution, which could easily adapt to its evolving needs, such as local currency planning, P&L dashboards, automated data feeds from ERP, and drill through details, balance sheet planning, etc. Offering an insight-rich and scalable finance reporting system to sustain its long-term, competitive advantage was the priority for the California-based customer. Moreover, it realized that it needed to re-evaluate and update its current planning processes to meet current and future business requirements.

Additionally, it was wanting to eliminate the following:

- Reliance on Excel spreadsheets to create financial planning, budgeting, forecasting and reporting across income, balance sheet and cash flow.
- Error-prone, disconnected and non-standardized reporting process.
- Difficult data collation from ERP system to create financial reports.

Solution

Forsys implemented Oracle Planning and Budgeting Cloud Service (PBCS) to streamline and automate the client's planning and budget forecast processes. As a proven Cloud Transformation expert and recognized Oracle Gold Certified, Cloud Excellence Implementation Partner, we helped the client remove its dependency on Excel spreadsheets, successfully switch to PBCS, and clock a 40-50% productivity jump.

Our solution approach included:

- Implemented Oracle PBCS to create financial reports.
- Created and set up an application in 2 Block Storage (BSO) –for item-level planning and consolidated planning – and 1 Aggregate Storage (ASO) cube for financial reporting.
- Configured the financials business process using several data entry forms and complex business rules (i.e., allocations, currency conversion, driver-based models).
- Loaded historical and GL Actuals, current & approved Budget, and the most recent forecast.
- Incorporated Local Currency Planning and Conversion.
- Secured recurring expense model that offloads and distributes responsibility from Financial Planning and Analysis (FP&A) team to the individual department owners.
- Integrated Oracle EBS into Hyperion for automated data loads and hierarchy maintenance.
- Analytics to empower the senior management to strategize the S&M and R&D investments from the human resources perspective.
- Flexible and scalable workforce planning model to plan and prepare for future growth accurately.

Benefits

After implementing PBCS, the client witnessed the following:

Driver-based configurable planning application deployment helped remove ongoing maintenance related to forecasting and budget planning models.

Elimination of the disparate planning models and manual consolidations using a role-based, secured and scalable planning application.

Developed efficient forecast and budget planning models by implementing a driver-based configurable planning application.

Business productivity jumped by 40-50% with the automation of budget & planning analysis and data accuracy.

FP&A team saved over 50% of their time, resulting in faster and more accurate close and forecast cycles.

Automated manual consolidations into the automated system using Oracle PBCS.

About the Client

The client is a consumer entertainment products company headquartered in Chatsworth, California. The company creates innovative proprietary and licensed products including toys and games, dolls, consumer electronics, home décor, stationery and sporting goods. Founded in 1979, the customer operates worldwide.

Technology/Tools

Oracle PBCS, Oracle Hyperion Financial Management, NetSuite, JIRA